

8. With reference to "Shaksgam Valley, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. This valley is a strategic key region, that is part of Pakistan-occupied Kashmir (P.oK).
2. India has lodged protest against the infrastructural development being carried out by China in this valley.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

- | | |
|------------|---------------------|
| (a) Only 2 | (b) Neither 1 nor 2 |
| (c) Only 1 | (d) Both 1 and 2 |

UPPSC (Pre) 2024

Ans. (d)

Under the so-called China- Pakistan 'Boundary Agreement' signed in 1963, Pakistan illegally ceded 5180 sq. km of territory in Shaksgam Valley (part of the Union Territory of Ladakh) to China.

This valley is a strategically important region. India has strongly opposed China's construction activities in the Shaksgam Valley. The Government of India has never recognized this boundary agreement and has consistently maintained that it is illegal and invalid. The entire territory of the Union Territories of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh is an integral and inseparable part of India. Thus, both statements are correct.

9. Which of the following is also called 'Molassis Basin'?

- | | |
|-------------|--------------|
| (a) Manipur | (b) Tripura |
| (c) Mizoram | (d) Nagaland |

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

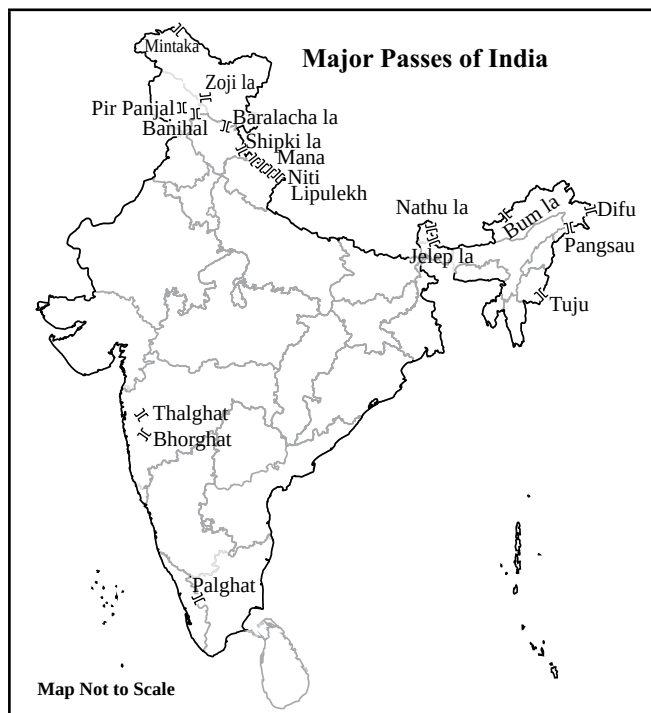
Mizoram is also called 'Molassis Basin', because Mizoram is composed of unconsolidated sediments. Significantly Mizoram is a hilly state in the North-East and is characterised by the presence of a homogenous tribal population. Notably, the common language of Mizoram is Lushai.

vi. Passes

*A Pass is a gap, or break, in high, rugged terrain such as a mountain ridge. A Pass is formed when a glacier or a stream erodes, or wears away, the land between the areas of higher terrain. Passes often provide the easiest routes for people to travel across steep mountain ranges.

*A Pass is a connectivity route through the basin of a mountain or mountain ranges. In India a lot of passes are found in the Himalayan region and the Western Ghats. These passes often become an essential medium for connectivity via roadways

and railways. *The **Karakoram Pass** is situated in the Ladakh UT. *The **Burzil Pass** provides a route between Srinagar and Gilgit. The Srinagar-Leh route passes through **Zoji La Pass**, which is situated in the Zaskar Range. The route from Kulgaon to Kothi passes through Pir Panjal Range. *The route from Jammu to Srinagar passes through **Banihal Pass**.



*The **Shipki La pass** is situated in the state of Himachal Pradesh. It provides a route that connects Himachal Pradesh to Tibet. *The **Baralacha La** pass provides a route between Manali and Leh. **Thang/Tanglang La** pass is situated in the Ladakh region. ***Mana Pass** which is also known as **Chirbitya La** and **Dungri La**, is situated in the Himalayan region of the country between India and Tibet. Mana Pass located in the state of Uttarakhand, extends from the Nanda Devi Biosphere Reserve to Tibet. Lake Deotal which is the source of river Saraswati, a tributary of river Alaknanda is situated in the Mana Pass. ***Lipu Lekh Pass** situated in the state of Uttarakhand lies on the Indo-China Border. The route for the Lake Mansarovar and Kailash Valley passes through Lipu Lekh and Nathu La passes.

***Nathu La Pass** is situated in Sikkim. Nathu La Pass extends upto Chumbi valley of Tibet Plateau region of China. Nathu La Pass is also the third Border Trade Point between India and China the other two being Lipulekh Pass of Uttarakhand and Shipkila Pass of Himachal Pradesh. Post 1962 Indo-China war both the **Lipulekh Pass** of Uttarakhand and **Shipki La** Pass of Himachal Pradesh were closed for any trade activities

between the two countries, however on 6th July, 2006 they were re-opened. *The **Jelep La pass**, situated in Sikkim, connects the Eastern Sikkim to Lhasa (Tibet).

***Bomdila pass** connects Arunachal Pradesh (Western Kameng District) to Lhasa (Tibet). ***Yang Yap pass** is located in the state of Arunachal Pradesh. The River Brahmaputra enters India near this pass. ***Diphu** and **Pangsau passes** which are situated in the state of Arunachal Pradesh lie on Indo-Myanmar Border. ***Tuju pass** (Manipur) located on south-east region provides a way from Imphal to Tamu and Myanmar.

*The Western Ghats extend from the mouth of the river Tapi in the north to the cape of Kanyakumari in the south covering 1500 km in landscape. ***Thalghat** situated in the state of Maharashtra, provides road and rail connectivity between Mumbai-Nagpur and Kolkata. ***Bhor Ghat Pass** also located in Maharashtra provides road and rail connectivity between Mumbai-Pune-Belagavi-Chennai. ***Palghat Gap** is a low mountain pass in the Western Ghats in Kerala, it connects Palakkad and Coimbatore the two main cities of South India. The pass is located between the Nilgiri Hills to the north and Anaimalai (Annamalai) Hills to the South.

Some other important passes of India are -

Chang La	- Ladakh
Bum La	- Arunachal Pradesh
Rohtang Pass	- Himachal Pradesh
Niti Pass	- Uttarakhand

Muling La Pass is a seasonal pass located to the North of Gangotri. It connects Uttarakhand to Tibet. In winter it gets covered with snow, hence it becomes inactive for traveling purposes.

1. Which one of the following is not correctly matched?

- | | |
|--------------|---------------------|
| (a) Chang La | - Jammu and Kashmir |
| (b) Rohtang | - Himachal Pradesh |
| (c) Bomdi La | - Arunachal Pradesh |
| (d) Se La | - Uttarakhand |

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (d)

The passes and their locations are as follows—	
Chang La	— Jammu and Kashmir
Rohtang	— Himachal Pradesh
Bomdi La	— Arunachal Pradesh
Se La	— Arunachal Pradesh
Thus option (d) is not correctly matched. In present scenario, Chang La pass is in Ladakh region i.e. Union Territory. (bifurcated from Jammu and Kashmir).	

2. Palghat is situated between :

- | |
|--|
| (a) The Nilgiris and the Cardamom Hills |
| (b) The Nilgiris and the Annamalai Hills |
| (c) The Annamalai Hills and the Cardamom Hills |
| (d) The Cardamom Hills and Palni Hills |

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

Palghat Pass is located between the Nilgiri Hills to the north and Annamalai (Anaimalai) Hills to the south. It is located in Kerala. Thalghat, Bhorghat and Palghat are main passes of Western Ghats.
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3. Which of the following is not correctly matched :

- | | |
|-------------------|---------------------|
| (a) Bomdi La Pass | - Arunachal Pradesh |
| (b) Nathu La Pass | - Sikkim |
| (c) Bhorghat Pass | - Himachal Pradesh |
| (d) Palghat | - Kerala |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (c)

Bomdi La Pass is located in Arunachal Pradesh in West Kameng district. Nathu La Pass is located in Sikkim. Bhorghat is located in Maharashtra which connects Mumbai and Pune. Palghat Gap is located in Kerala which connects Palakkad and Coimbatore.
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4. Which of the following is NOT a pass in the Western Ghats Mountain ranges?

- | | |
|-----------------|--------------|
| (a) Thalghat | (b) Bhorghat |
| (c) Khyber Pass | (d) Palghat |

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (c)

The Khyber Pass is located in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province (formerly NWFP) of Pakistan. It falls on the border between Pakistan's and Afghanistan. Thalghat is near the town of Kasara in Maharashtra. It is along the busy Mumbai-Nashik route. Bhor ghat links Mumbai with Pune. Palghat connects Kerala and Tamil Nadu (Connecting-Palakkad and Coimbatore).

5. Which one of the following is not correctly matched:

- | |
|----------------------------------|
| (a) Shipki La - Himachal Pradesh |
| (b) Lipulekh – Uttar Pradesh |

- (c) Nathu La – Sikkim
(d) Zojila - Kashmir

U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) 2001
U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (b)

Lipulekh Pass is located on India- China border in Uttarakhand not in Uttar Pradesh.

6. Which of the following is not correctly matched?

- | | |
|---------------|---------------------|
| (a) Shipki La | - Himachal Pradesh |
| (b) Bomdi La | - Arunachal Pradesh |
| (c) Nathu La | - Meghalaya |
| (d) Zoji La | - Jammu & Kashmir |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (c)

Nathu La Pass is located on India - China border in Sikkim not in Meghalaya.

7. Nathu La Pass is situated in which state ?

- | | |
|---------------|------------|
| (a) Arunachal | (b) Assam |
| (c) Meghalaya | (d) Sikkim |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (d)

Nathu La is a mountain pass in the Himalayan region situated at a height of 4310 m (14,140 feet) above sea level. On the Indian side, the pass is 55 km east of Gangtok, the capital of Sikkim and opens in to Chumbi Valley in Tibet. Nathu La is one of the three open trading border posts between India and China, the others being Shipki La in Himachal Pradesh and Lipulekh in Uttarakhand.

8. Which of the following Passes lead to Leh?

- | | |
|-------------------|---------------|
| (a) Zozila | (b) Shipki La |
| (c) Chumbi Valley | (d) Banihal |

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

Zozila Pass is a high mountain pass in Ladakh located on the Indian National Highway-1 between Uri and Leh.

9. Zoji-la Tunnel will connect which of the following places ?

- (a) Manali and Jammu
(b) Manali and Lahaul Spiti valley
(c) Srinagar and Leh
(d) Srinagar and Jammu

70th B.P.S.C. Pre-2024

Ans. (c)

The Zoji-la Tunnel is an under-construction tunnel in the Kargil district of the Union Territory of Ladakh & Jammu and Kashmir, India. It is located on the Srinagar-Kargil-Leh highway beneath the Zojila Pass between Ganderbal (Jammu and Kashmir) and Drass in Kargil. This tunnel is being constructed to connect Srinagar (Kashmir Valley) and Leh (Ladakh) and will provide all-weather road connectivity between the two regions.

10. Which one of the following Himalayan Passes was reopened around the middle of the year 2006 to facilitate trade between India and China ?

- | | |
|--------------|---------------|
| (a) Chang La | (b) Jara La |
| (c) Nathu La | (d) Shipki La |

I.A.S. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (c)

Nathu La pass was reopened in 2006 following numerous bilateral trade negotiations after 1962 Indo-China War.

11. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below :

List-I (Mountain Pass)	List-II (State)
A. Banihal	1. Himachal Pradesh
B. Nathu La	2. Jammu and Kashmir
C. Niti	3. Sikkim
D. Shipki	4. Uttaranchal
Code :	

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	1	4	3
(b)	2	3	4	1
(c)	4	3	1	2
(d)	3	4	2	1

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2004

Ans. (b)

The correct match is as follows :

(Mountain Pass)	(State)
Banihal	Jammu and Kashmir (Now UT)
Nathu La	Sikkim
Niti	Uttarakhand (formerly Uttaranchal)
Shipki La	Himachal Pradesh

12. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the Lists :

List-I (Mountain Pass)	List-II (State)
A. Bum La	1. Arunachal Pradesh
B. Jelep La	2. Himachal Pradesh

C. Muling La

D. Shipki La

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	3	4
(b)	1	3	4	2
(c)	4	3	2	1
(d)	3	1	4	2

3. Sikkim

4. Uttarakhand

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2006

Ans. (b)

The correct match of Mountain Pass and the corresponding state is as follows.

Mountain Pass	-	State
Bum La	-	Arunachal Pradesh
Jelep La	-	Sikkim
Muling La	-	Uttarakhand
Shipki La	-	Himachal Pradesh

13. Match the List-I and List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below :

List -I (Mountain Pass)	List-II (State)
A. Mana	1. Sikkim
B. Nathu La	2. Jammu and Kashmir
C. Zozi La	3. Himachal Pradesh
D. Shipki La	4. Uttarakhand

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	3	1	4
(b)	4	3	2	1
(c)	4	1	2	3
(d)	4	1	3	2

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

The correct match of the given Mountain Passes and States is as follows –

(Mountain Pass)	(State)
Mana	- Uttarakhand
Nathu La	- Sikkim
Zozi La	- Jammu and Kashmir
Shipki La	- Himachal Pradesh

Note : Now Zozi La Pass is situated in the Ladakh UT.

14. Which of the following is not a correct match ?

Passes	State
(a) Jelep La	- Sikkim
(b) Mana and Niti	- Uttarakhand
(c) Shipki La	- Jammu and Kashmir
(d) Bom Di La	- Arunachal Pradesh

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

Shipki La is a mountain pass and border post on the Indo-China border. It is located in Kinnaur district of Himachal Pradesh not in Jammu and Kashmir. The rest of the passes are correctly matched with their States.

15. Which one of the following (Passes – States/U.T.) is correctly matched?

- (a) Mana – Himachal Pradesh
- (b) Niti – Uttarakhand
- (c) Diphu – Ladakh
- (d) Aghil – Arunachal Pradesh

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

The correct matching of Passes and States/U.T. is as follows :

Mana	-	Uttarakhand
Niti	-	Uttarakhand
Diphu	-	Arunachal Pradesh
Aghil	-	Ladakh

16. Which one of the following passes is located in Uttarakhand ?

- (a) Jelep La
- (b) Lipulekh
- (c) Nathu La
- (d) Shipki

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (b)

Jelep La is located in eastern Sikkim between India and Tibet. Lipulekh Pass is located in Pithoragarh district of Uttarakhand. It provides entry to Mansarovar lake through Kailash Valley. Nathu La is located in Sikkim whereas Shipki-la is located in Himachal Pradesh.

17. Lipulekh Pass is situated in –

- (a) Jammu and Kashmir
- (b) Himachal Pradesh
- (c) Uttarakhand
- (d) Arunachal Pradesh
- (e) Western Ghats

Chhattisgarh P.C.S (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

18. Which one of the following is not correctly matched ?

- (a) Nathu La - Arunachal Pradesh
(b) Lipulekh - Uttarakhand
(c) Rohtang - Himachal Pradesh
(d) Palghat - Kerala

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2013

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2010

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (a)

The correct order of Passes and related States is as follows:

Pass	State
Nathu La	- Sikkim
Lipulekh	- Uttarakhand
Rohtang	- Himachal Pradesh
Palghat	- Kerala

19. Rohtang pass is located in –

- (a) Himachal Pradesh (b) Jammu and Kashmir
(c) Sikkim (d) Uttarakhand

U.P. Lower Sub.(Pre) 2009

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

20. Mana Pass is located in –

- (a) Uttar Pradesh (b) Uttarakhand
(c) Jammu & Kashmir (d) Himachal Pradesh

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (b)

Mana Pass is located in the Himalayan Region between India and Tibet. It is also known as Dungri La. It is located in Nanda Devi Biosphere Reserve, Uttarakhand Deotal lake is located in this pass, where river Saraswati, a tributary of Alaknanda originates.

21. What are Kingri-Wingri, Neeti-Mana?

- (a) Passes (b) Rivers
(c) Mountains (d) Religious places

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

Kingri-Wingri and Neeti-Mana are passes located in Uttarakhand. Neeti is an important pass of the Himalayas that connects Uttarakhand to Tibet. Mana pass which is also called as Dungri La is located between India and Tibet. Deotal lake which is the source of Saraswati river (tributary of Alaknanda) is situated in this pass.

22. Which of the following options represents correct order of mountain passes from west to east

I. Shipki La

II. Nathu La

III. Bomdi La

IV. Lipulekh

Code :

(a) I, II, III, IV

(b) II, III, IV, I

(c) I, IV, II, III

(d) III, II, I, IV

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (c)

The correct order of mountain passes from west to east is Shipki La (Himachal Pradesh), Lipulekh (Uttarakhand), Nathu La (Sikkim) and Bomdi La (Arunachal Pradesh).

23. The Pass, which is situated at the highest elevation, is

- (a) Zoji La (b) Rohtang
(c) Nathu La (d) Khyber
(e) None of the above/more than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (e)

According to first four options Nathu La is situated at the highest elevation. Nathu La is in Sikkim at an elevation of approximately 4310 m, followed by Rohtang (Himachal Pradesh) at 3978 m (approx.), Zojila (Ladakh) at 3528 m (approx.) and Khyber (Pakistan) at 1070 m (approx). However Yangzi Diwan is the India's highest Pass, since none of the above is given as an option. Therefore, option (e) will be the right answer.

24. Match List-I with List-II and choose the correct answer using the codes given below in the lists:

List-I

List-II

(Pass)

(Height from Sea Level)

A. Debsa

1. 5360 metres

B. Rohtang

2. 4850 metres

C. Bara-lacha

3. 3978 metres

D. Banihal

4. 2832 metres

Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a) 1	3	2	4	
(b) 3	1	2	4	
(c) 1	4	2	3	
(d) 3	1	4	2	

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Ans. (a)